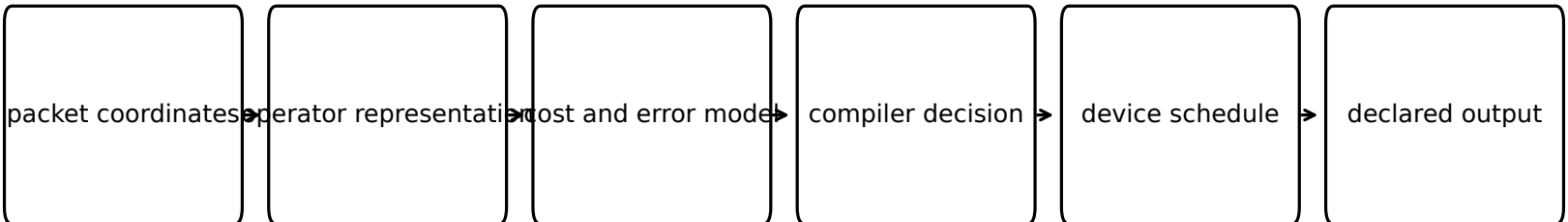A packet computation is specified before it is scheduled